

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 26, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 31:1-18

1 Now it came to pass in the eleventh year, in the third month, on the first day of the month, that the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 "Son of man, say to Pharaoh king of Egypt and to his multitude: 'Whom are you like in your greatness?

3 Indeed Assyria was a cedar in Lebanon, With fine branches that shaded the forest, And of high stature; And its top was among the thick boughs.

4 The waters made it grow; Underground waters gave it height, With their rivers running around the place where it was planted, And sent out rivulets to all the trees of the field.

5 Therefore its height was exalted above all the trees of the field; Its boughs were multiplied, And its branches became long because of the abundance of water, As it sent them out.

6 All the birds of the heavens made their nests in its boughs; Under its branches all the beasts of the field brought forth their young; And in its shadow all great nations made their home.

7 Thus it was beautiful in greatness and in the length of its branches, Because its roots reached to abundant waters.

8 The cedars in the garden of God could not hide it; The fir trees were not like its boughs, And the chestnut trees were not like its branches; No tree in the garden of God was like it in beauty.

9 I made it beautiful with a multitude of branches, So that all the trees of Eden envied it, That were in the garden of God.'

10 "Therefore thus says the Lord God: 'Because you have increased in height, and it set its top among the thick boughs, and its heart was lifted up in its height,

11 therefore I will deliver it into the hand of the mighty one of the nations, and he shall

surely deal with it; I have driven it out for its wickedness.

12 And aliens, the most terrible of the nations, have cut it down and left it; its branches have fallen on the mountains and in all the valleys; its boughs lie broken by all the rivers of the land; and all the peoples of the earth have gone from under its shadow and left it.

13 On its ruin will remain all the birds of the heavens, And all the beasts of the field will come to its branches—

14 So that no trees by the waters may ever again exalt themselves for their height, nor set their tops among the thick boughs, that no tree which drinks water may ever be high enough to reach up to them. For they have all been delivered to death, To the depths of the earth, Among the children of men who go down to the Pit.'

15 "Thus says the Lord God: 'In the day when it went down to hell, I caused mourning. I covered the deep because of it. I restrained its rivers, and the great waters were held back. I caused Lebanon to mourn for it, and all the trees of the field wilted because of it.

16 I made the nations shake at the sound of its fall, when I cast it down to hell together with those who descend into the Pit; and all the trees of Eden, the choice and best of Lebanon, all that drink water, were comforted in the depths of the earth.

17 They also went down to hell with it, with those slain by the sword; and those who were its strong arm dwelt in its shadows among the nations.

18 'To which of the trees in Eden will you then be likened in glory and greatness? Yet you shall be brought down with the trees of Eden to the depths of the earth; you shall lie in the midst of the uncircumcised, with those slain by the sword. This is Pharaoh and all his multitude,' says the Lord God."

II. Key Summary

- Continuing the judgment prophecy against Egypt from the previous passage (30:10-26), God tells Ezekiel to speak to Pharaoh, comparing Assyria to a towering, lush cedar in Lebanon—so magnificent that even the trees in the garden of God and in Eden could not match it and envied it (31:2-9).
- God says that because the tree grew tall and its heart was proud, He handed it over to the mighty one of the nations; aliens cut it down and left it, and all the peoples left its shade (31:10-14).
- God says that on the day it went down to the Pit the nations trembled, and it went

down together with those who had relied on it; and He states that Pharaoh and all his multitude are just like this (31:15-18).

III. Passage Analysis

Your Greatness Was Planted by God

Assyria forgot that its success came through the grace of God, and this led to its destruction. [1]

The tree grew so tall and beautiful only because God gave it water and made it grow (v4, v9); its splendor was never something it earned on its own. The previous passage (30:10-26) already said God is the source of strength; here the same truth comes through a great tree—everything in your hands starts with God.

The Moment Pride Creeps In, Height Becomes the Reason for the Fall

A proud heart will in the end lead to ruin. [2]

There was nothing wrong with the tree being tall; what ruined it was its "proud heart" (v10)—taking what God gave and treating it as its own achievement, then swelling up with self-importance. The warning to Egypt runs the same way: the higher you stand, the easier it is to forget who you are.

IV. Reflection Question

When you're around people who are clearly stronger than you, is your usual reaction to envy them, or to want to lean on them?

In this chapter the great tree—the one every nation sheltered under and even the trees of Eden envied—still falls and goes down to the Pit; pinning your hopes on someone who can collapse is never secure.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website, Bible Intensive Reading Commentary (聖經精讀本), <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT31.htm>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website, Tang Yau-chi, Tien Dao Bible Commentary — Ezekiel (唐佑之《天道聖經註釋——以西結書》),
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT31.htm>